missiles in Turkey, but he no longer seemed to care. The Central Committee secretary in charge of ideology, Leonid Ilichev, was personally tasked by Khrushchev with hand-delivering the letter to the Soviet Radio Committee. Ilichev recalled that his driver violated all speed limits and traffic rules as he sped from Novo-Ogarevo to the center of Moscow to deliver the letter. He made it on time. At 5:00 p.m. Moscow time, an announcer began reading Khrushchev's message to Kennedy.

In Washington, DC, it was 9:00 a.m. It was Sunday morning, and Kennedy had no intention of delivering a new address to the nation. The address that had so frightened Khrushchev and his colleagues and made them speed up the delivery of their letter to Kennedy was never planned. Soviet military spies had picked up information about a rebroadcast of Kennedy's speech of October 22. Like many other episodes of the Cuban crisis, it was a mistake—a case of one side completely unable to understand the other. Not only did the Soviets confuse what they heard on television and radio, perhaps because of poor knowledge of English, but they also had little understanding of American politics and culture. Had Kennedy intended to deliver a televised address on Sunday, October 29, he would not have scheduled it for 9:00 a.m., when he and his fellow citizens were heading for church services. That did not occur to operatives of the officially atheist Soviet Union. It was a double mistake, but a lucky one. By now, not only was war off the table, but a proposed solution to the crisis was on the air.[26]